

3
>>>

In the example above, function has been added to the application at runtime. Again, the emphasis is not on the fact that this can be done, but consider the simplicity and readability of the code. A person does not have to even know Python to get the idea of what the code intends to do.

Prof. Dijkstra wrote, “If you want more effective programmers, you will discover that they should not waste their time debugging; they should not introduce the bugs to start with.” (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Edsger_W._Dijkstra)

This is where Python appears to do well. It appears to allow you to program fairly complex algorithms concisely and retain readability. Hence, the likelihood of introducing bugs to start with is minimised.

On the importance of which programming languages to teach, Prof. Dijkstra wrote, “It is not only the violin that shapes the violinist; we are all shaped by the tools we train ourselves to use, and in this respect, programming languages have a devious influence: they shape our thinking habits.” (<http://chrisonedone.com/posts/dijkstra-haskell-java>)

It is not surprising that Python is widely used for AI. It is easy to integrate Python with C/C++, and it has a wide range of inbuilt libraries. But most of all, it is easy to experiment with new ideas and explore prototypes in Python.

It is definitely a language all programmers should include in their toolkits. 

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The author has earned the right to do what interests him. You can find him online at <http://sethanil.com>, <http://sethanil.blogspot.com>, and reach him via email at anil@sethanil.com.

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